39th Convocation 2026 (May Edition)
16 May 2026
Salutations (PM) for

YBhg Prof Emeritus Datuk Ts Ir Dr Siti Hamisah Tapsir
UCSI University president and vice-chancellor

Yang Amat Mulia Tunku Zain Al-'Abidin ibni Tuanku Muhriz
UCSI University chancellor

Yang Berbahagia Dato' Peter Ng
UCSI University Council chairman

Members of the UCSI University Council

Members of the Senate and Management of UCSI University

Ambassadors and embassy representatives

Honourable guests

Parents and graduates of the Class of 2026

Assalamualaikum warahmatullahi wabarakatuh and good morning. A warm welcome to everyone, especially to those of you who are visiting UCSI University for the very first time. Welcome to UCSI and welcome to the first session of UCSI's 39th Convocation Ceremony.

And to our superstars of the day, our graduands – today is your day, and I hope you know just how proud we are of each and every one of you. Congratulations to the Class of 2026!

Of course, none of us ever reach milestones like this alone. This moment also belongs to the people who stood beside you throughout your journey. Your parents, family members, friends, lecturers and loved ones who supported you every step of the way. Their sacrifices, encouragement and belief in you have helped shape the person you are today.

So graduands, may I invite all of you to rise. Turn to your pillars of support and give them a big round of applause.

In a few moments, you will be walking across this very stage to receive your scroll – a symbol of years of hard work and sacrifices. Behind every sleepless night, thanks to the countless cups of coffee and cans of Red Bull or Monster Energy for every assignment submitted and every examination completed, was a dream that you chose not to give up on. Sure, there were moments of stress, moments of doubt and moment when you questioned whether you could keep going. Yet here you are today, stronger than when you first walked through the doors of UCSI all those years ago.

Graduands,

Beyond these walls lies a world experiencing immense change. We are witnessing global conflicts, shifting economic landscapes, climate-related challenges and perhaps one of the most transformative developments of our generation, the rapid rise of artificial intelligence.

Technology is reshaping how we work, how we learn and how we live. It is creating new opportunities, improving productivity and opening doors that were once unimaginable. At the same time, it is also disrupting industries and changing the nature of many jobs. Some roles will disappear, others will evolve and many new ones will emerge. This is the reality of the world you are graduating into: a world that is fast-moving, uncertain and constantly changing.

But it is also a world full of possibility.

In times like these, the most valuable skill you can possess is the willingness to keep learning. The education you received here at UCSI is not simply about memorising facts or earning a qualification. It is about developing the ability to think critically, to adapt confidently and to continue growing throughout your life. The future will belong to those who are prepared not only to learn, but also to unlearn and relearn.

Today, 1,214 of you join the ranks of graduates from a university ranked among the world's top 1%. You are now part of a global alumni community that continues to make meaningful contributions across industries and societies around the world.

Yet your greatest strength will never be something that can be replicated by a machine. A machine may process information faster and boost productivity unlike anything we have ever seen, but it cannot replace empathy, compassion, integrity or purpose. It cannot truly understand human struggle, inspire hope or lead with heart.

Do not underestimate your ability to empathise, to understand people and to lead with compassion. Your creativity in solving problems with humanity and compassion, as well as your ability to communicate and collaborate across different perspectives are the exact qualities that will distinguish you. These are the values UCSI has sought to nurture in you from the moment you first stepped onto campus: resilience, adaptability, open-mindedness and courage.

And as you venture into this new phase of your life, hold firmly to your values. There will be moments when doing the right thing is not always the easiest thing. There will be situations that test your integrity and challenge your principles. In those moments, I hope you remain grounded in who you are and what you stand for.

We live in a time where individual comfort and success are often prioritised above all else. And it is easy to subscribe to that mindset, as it places self-importance, self-reliance and self-interest above everything else. However, real progress has never been achieved alone. Every meaningful advancement in society - be it science, education, healthcare or social justice - has always been built through collective effort. We move forward not as isolated individuals, but as communities connected by a shared responsibility to make the world a better place.

So wherever life takes you, never lose your awareness of others. Use your education not only to build successful careers, but also to uplift people around you. Success becomes far more meaningful when it creates positive change beyond ourselves.

And finally, carry with you a sense of grit. Life will not always go according to plan. There will be setbacks, disappointments and moments of uncertainty. But your ability to push through adversity will define your journey far more than your achievements alone.

Stay curious. Stay humble. Stay resilient. Most importantly, stay purposeful.

Because the future will not simply be shaped by technology, industries or institutions. It will be shaped by people. People with compassion, courage and conviction. People like all of you seated before us today.

Once again, congratulations to the Class of 2026. We are proud of you, we celebrate you and we cannot wait to see the impact you will make on the world. Thank you.